

MEDICATIONS AND DRIVING

There's more than one way to be under the influence.

Impaired driving is generally associated with alcohol, cannabis, or illegal drug use. However, many legally obtained and commonly used over-the-counter and prescription drugs can impact a user's ability to drive safely.

- Just because a drug is legal does not mean it is safe to use while driving.
- Impaired driving is a criminal behavior. It doesn't matter if the drug is prescribed, obtained over-the-counter, bought in a retail setting, or considered an illicit substance.

Over-the-counter drugs taken for headaches, colds, or allergies can make a person drowsy, which could affect your driving. Like alcohol, prescription drugs can affect your reflexes, judgment, vision, and alertness.

Do not drive if you just started taking prescription drugs for the first time, started taking a new prescription medicine, or started taking a higher dose of a current drug. Wait until you know what effect it has on your judgment, coordination, and reaction time. Talk to your doctor or pharmacist. Read all warning labels before driving. Warnings against "operating heavy machinery" include driving a vehicle.

Some medications might not impact you on their own, but if taken with a second medication or alcohol, they could cause severe impairment. Many drugs multiply the effects of alcohol or have other side effects. Read the warnings on your medicine or talk to your pharmacist before you drink and use medicine at the same time.